

....Church of....

THE SACRED HEART

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Shonnard Place

Yonkers, N.Y., January 3rd 2 P M, 1916

Mrs. Margaret Casey LeDoux
Portland Oregon.

My Dear Sister Margaret:-

I must try and answer your pleasant letter and beautiful boquet received this morning with one from Leo also. Really, Margaret, such letters and especially the fragrance of such a boquet is good for a sick person to receive. Not that I am exactly sick, but I've had a touch of le grippe these few days with quite a cold in the chest and head. The latter cold seems softer since reading these letters. Ha Ha Margaret, quite a new remedy for a bad cold! I am glad to hear that you are all well out there. Thanks Be to God! May He continue His favors, temporal and spiritual to all in Portland and their friends! I hope you had a happy gathering on New Years Day, as you were anticipating. I think I would enjoy calling on your crowd but under the circumstances I cannot just "drop in for a few minutes" even. I do not complain of such circumstances. Rather on the contrary I can never be grateful enough to God for disposing things in my regard and in regard to our whole Family so mercifully as He has done. Surely the natural scene now before me when I turn my head to look at it is as picturesque as any scene of long ago - the mouth of the Hudson shining like a silver lake away in the horizon in the clouds I was going to say with hills and vallies and human achievement between. But what is nature in the light of the supernatural? Ah, a substratum! And what are natural blessing with hope of immortality? I believe that I'd go crazy, yearning for something higher if I had nothing to enjoy or to hope for but the natural - even had I all the natural gifts and blessings ever enjoyed by man. But thanks be to God for the True Faith! Thanks be to God for the simple honest, faithful parents that God gave us! Thanks be to God for vocation and for strength to follow the call, at least imperfectly! Thanks be to God for the blessed hope that He gives us here in our exile of once being eternally united with His chosen ones in the peace of our true home, in the love of His Sacred Heart! What are the struggles and victories of men, if only natural? What are they all compared with the victorious struggles of a Christian soul leaving its exile to brighten Heaven!